



Essential Learning Map — Modeled Examples

A completed Map for each subject and grade, to model the end product teams are building toward by Meeting 8.

Each example below is a completed Essential Learning Map — the end product a team should have by Meeting 8. The rows follow the four steps of the Map: essential standard (Step 1), learning targets (Step 2), success criteria (Step 3), and proficiency anchors (Step 4). Share the example closest to a team's subject and grade as a model, not a script — their exact wording comes from their own course standards.

Standards are paraphrased from the California and NGSS frameworks to show the pattern. The anchors are brief illustrations — real anchors are written by the team for their own priority target.

Core subjects

Math · Grade 6

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Understand ratio concepts and use ratio and rate reasoning to solve real-world problems, including unit rate and percent. (6.RP.A)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can describe a ratio relationship between two quantities. (Reasoning) • I can find a unit rate and use it to solve problems. (Skill) • I can use ratio reasoning to solve percent problems. (Skill)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Sets up a correct ratio or rate, shows the reasoning (table, double number line, or equation), solves accurately, and labels the answer with correct units.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	For “12 oranges cost \$4 — how much for 18?” the student finds a unit rate (3 oranges per \$1), shows a ratio table or equation, solves (\$6), and labels the units.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student adds or guesses (“6 more, so about \$10”) with no unit rate, or gives a bare number with no units and no shown reasoning.

Math · Grade 7

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Recognize and represent proportional relationships between quantities. (7.RP.A.2)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can decide whether two quantities are proportional using a table, graph, or equation. (Reasoning) • I can identify the constant of proportionality (unit rate). (Skill) • I can write the equation $y = kx$ for a proportional relationship. (Skill)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Correctly determines proportionality with evidence, identifies the constant k , writes $y = kx$, and interprets a point in context.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	From a table the student checks that y/x is constant ($k = 2.5$), states “proportional because the ratio is constant,” writes $y = 2.5x$, and reads (1, 2.5) as the unit rate.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student calls it proportional because “the numbers go up,” without checking a constant ratio, or finds k but cannot write the equation.

Math · Grade 8

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Understand the connections between proportional relationships, lines, and linear equations, including slope. (8.EE.B.5–6)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can graph a proportional relationship and interpret slope as a unit rate. (Skill) • I can explain why slope is the same between any two points on a line. (Reasoning) • I can derive the equation $y = mx + b$. (Reasoning)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Graphs accurately, computes slope correctly, and connects slope to the rate of change in the situation.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student graphs two plans, finds slopes of 3 and 5, and explains “Plan B is \$5 per unit, so it rises faster” — using slope as a rate of change.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student computes a slope but reverses rise and run, or cannot say what the slope means in the context.

ELA · Grade 6

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Determine a central idea of a text and cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and inferentially. (RI.6.1–2)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can identify the central idea of a text. (Reasoning) • I can cite explicit and inferential evidence that supports it. (Skill) • I can explain how the evidence develops the central idea. (Reasoning)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	States an accurate central idea, cites at least two relevant pieces of evidence (one explicit, one inferred), and explains how each connects to the idea.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student names an accurate central idea, quotes two pieces of text (one stated, one inferred), and explains in a sentence how each supports the idea.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student retells the topic instead of a central idea, or gives evidence with no explanation of how it connects.

ELA · Grade 7

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence. (W.7.1)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can write a clear, arguable claim. (Product) • I can support my claim with relevant evidence and reasoning. (Reasoning) • I can acknowledge and respond to a counterclaim. (Reasoning)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	The claim is arguable and clear; at least two relevant pieces of evidence appear; reasoning ties each to the claim; a counterclaim is acknowledged and rebutted.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	An arguable thesis, two text-based pieces of evidence each explained with reasoning that links back to the claim, and a counterclaim named and answered.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	A claim that is just a fact or opinion with no “why,” evidence dropped in without explanation, or no counterclaim at all.

ELA · Grade 8

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Determine a theme of a literary text, analyze its development over the text, and provide an objective summary. (RL.8.2)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can identify a theme and trace how it develops. (Reasoning) • I can explain how characters, setting, and plot shape the theme. (Reasoning) • I can write an objective summary. (Skill)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Names a valid theme, cites two to three moments showing its development, explains the connection, and includes an opinion-free summary.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student states a theme as a full idea (not one word), tracks it across two or three moments in the text, and gives a summary free of personal opinion.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The theme is a single word (“friendship”), no development is traced, or the summary includes opinion (“it was a good book”).

Science · Grade 6

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Apply scientific principles of energy transfer to analyze or design a device that minimizes or maximizes thermal energy transfer. (MS-PS3-3)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can explain how thermal energy moves by conduction, convection, and radiation. (Knowledge) • I can use evidence to show how a design affects energy transfer. (Reasoning) • I can design or critique a device that controls heat transfer. (Product)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Correctly explains the mechanism of heat transfer, uses data or evidence to justify design choices, and connects the design back to the science principle.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student's cooler design names the transfer type (conduction), uses temperature data to justify the insulation choice, and ties it back to the principle.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The design works, but the student cannot name the transfer mechanism or justify the choices with data.

Science · Grade 7

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Develop and use a model to describe how the body is a system of interacting subsystems composed of cells. (MS-LS1-3)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can describe the function of key cell parts. (Knowledge) • I can explain how cells form tissues, organs, and systems. (Reasoning) • I can model how body systems interact. (Product)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	The model accurately shows the hierarchy from cells to systems, labels functions, and explains at least one interaction between systems with correct cause and effect.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The model shows cells → tissues → organs → systems with labels and shows how the respiratory and circulatory systems work together to move oxygen.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The model lists parts but does not show the hierarchy or any interaction between systems.

Science · Grade 8

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Plan an investigation to provide evidence that the change in an object's motion depends on the sum of the forces and the mass of the object. (MS-PS2-2)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can find the net force on an object. (Skill) • I can predict how net force and mass affect motion. (Reasoning) • I can plan an investigation that controls variables. (Product)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Correctly diagrams forces and net force, predicts the change in motion, and designs a fair test that controls variables and names the data to collect.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student diagrams the forces, finds the net force, predicts greater acceleration with more force or less mass, and plans a test that holds mass constant while changing force.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student predicts motion but changes more than one variable at once, or does not say what data to collect.

Social Studies · Grade 6

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Analyze how geography influenced the political, economic, religious, and social structures of an early civilization (e.g., Mesopotamia, Egypt, Indus Valley). (CA HSS 6)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can explain how geography shaped a civilization's development. (Reasoning) • I can describe key features of its social, political, or economic structure. (Knowledge) • I can use evidence to compare two civilizations. (Reasoning)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Uses specific evidence to connect geography to development and accurately describes at least two structures using correct terms.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student explains how the Nile's flooding enabled Egyptian agriculture and a centralized government, citing specific evidence and correct terms.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student states "rivers were important" without connecting geography to a specific structure or giving evidence.

Social Studies · Grade 7

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Analyze the causes and effects of the exchange of goods, ideas, and disease among civilizations in the medieval and early modern world. (CA HSS 7)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can identify major networks of exchange, such as trade routes. (Knowledge) • I can explain how exchange changed societies. (Reasoning) • I can support a cause-and-effect claim with evidence. (Reasoning)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Identifies specific exchanges and explains at least two effects with accurate evidence and correct chronology.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student traces the Silk Road's spread of goods and the Black Death, explaining two effects with accurate evidence and in the right sequence.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student lists trade routes but does not connect them to specific effects, or mixes up the chronology.

Social Studies · Grade 8

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Analyze the causes and consequences of a major development in early U.S. history (e.g., the Constitution, westward expansion, the Civil War), using evidence. (CA HSS 8)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can explain the causes of the development. (Reasoning) • I can describe its consequences for different groups. (Reasoning) • I can support an argument with primary and secondary sources. (Skill)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Makes a clear claim, cites at least two sources, explains both cause and consequence, and considers more than one group's perspective.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student argues a cause of the Civil War, cites a primary and a secondary source, and explains consequences for more than one group.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student describes the event but gives only one cause, no sources, or only one group's perspective.

Electives & specials

CTE · Intro to Engineering & Design (6–8)

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Apply the engineering design process to define a problem and develop, test, and refine a solution within given constraints.
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can define a problem with clear criteria and constraints. (Reasoning) • I can build and test a prototype. (Product) • I can refine my solution using test data. (Reasoning)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	States the problem with clear criteria and constraints, documents the design and at least one improvement based on test data, and evaluates the final solution against the criteria.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student states the criteria and constraints, tests the prototype, records data, makes a documented improvement, and evaluates the result against the criteria.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student builds something but does not test it with data or make a justified change.

Visual & Performing Arts · Visual Arts (6–8)

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Create a work of art that applies the elements of art and principles of design to communicate an idea, and refine it based on feedback. (Creating)
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can use elements of art and principles of design intentionally. (Skill) • I can connect my choices to the idea I am communicating. (Reasoning) • I can revise my work from critique. (Product)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Shows intentional use of at least two elements and one principle, communicates a clear idea, and reflects a revision made from feedback.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The piece uses contrast and color intentionally to convey a mood; the student explains the choices and shows a change made after critique.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student finishes a piece but cannot connect the choices to an idea, or made no change from feedback.

Physical Education · Movement & Strategy (6–8)

Essential standard (Step 1 · M5)	Demonstrate and apply movement skills and strategies in a physical activity or game, and explain how they contribute to skillful performance and fitness.
Learning targets (Step 2 · M6)	• I can perform the key mechanics of a movement skill. (Skill) • I can apply a strategy during a game. (Reasoning) • I can explain how the skill or strategy connects to fitness. (Knowledge)
Success criteria (Step 3 · M7)	Demonstrates correct mechanics consistently, applies an appropriate strategy in gameplay, and can explain why it works.
Proficient anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student performs the overhand throw with correct mechanics, uses a give-and-go in the game, and explains how it creates an open shot.
Not-yet anchor (Step 4 · M8)	The student performs the skill inconsistently, or cannot explain the purpose of the strategy.